

| Canon            | Canon                | Canon                | Canon                | Canon                |
|------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| SX240 HS         | Ixus 125 HS          | Ixus 140 HS          | Ixus 255 HS          | Ixus 500 HS          |
| 14,995           | 11,995               | 12,495               | 12,995               | 14,995               |
| 7.12             | 7.62                 | 7.6                  | 7.38                 | 6.54                 |
| 24.96            | 21.76                | 23.4                 | 25.32                | 25.4                 |
| 19.95            | 17.64                | 18                   | 18.9                 | 18.9                 |
| 4                | 3                    | 3.5                  | 4                    | 4                    |
| 4                | 3.3                  | 3.5                  | 3.5                  | 2.8                  |
| 60.03            | 53.32                | 56                   | 59.1                 | 57.64                |
| 12               | 16                   | 16                   | 12                   | 10                   |
| 1/2.3"           | 1/2.3"               | 1/2.3"               | 1/2.3"               | 1/2.3"               |
| 25               | 24                   | 28                   | 24                   | 28                   |
| 500              | 120                  | 224                  | 240                  | 336                  |
| 100              | 100                  | 100                  | 80                   | 100                  |
| 3200             | 3200                 | 1600                 | 6400                 | 3200                 |
| —                | —                    | —                    | —                    | —                    |
| 3.5              | 2.7                  | 3.2                  | 3                    | 3.4                  |
| 6.8              | 5.9                  | 6.9                  | 6.9                  | 5.6                  |
| 5                | 3                    | 1                    | 1                    | 1                    |
| N                | N                    | Y                    | Y                    | N                    |
| Y                | Y                    | Y                    | Y                    | Y                    |
| ±2 EV            | ±2 EV                | ±2 EV                | ±2 EV                | ±2 EV                |
| Y                | N                    | N                    | N                    | N                    |
| Y                | N                    | N                    | N                    | N                    |
| 2                | 5.8                  | 2.9                  | 6.2                  | 6.8                  |
| N                | N                    | N                    | N                    | N                    |
| 3                | 3                    | 3                    | 3                    | 3                    |
| 4,61,000         | 4,61,000             | 4,61,000             | 4,61,000             | 4,61,000             |
| N                | N                    | N                    | N                    | N                    |
| N                | N                    | N                    | N                    | N                    |
| Y                | Y                    | Y                    | Y                    | Y                    |
| Stereo           | Mono                 | Mono                 | Mono                 | Mono                 |
| y                | N                    | N                    | N                    | Y                    |
| 1080p            | 720p                 | 720p                 | 720p                 | 720p                 |
| Li-ion           | Li-ion               | Li-ion               | Li-ion               | Li-ion               |
| 230              | 170                  | 190                  | 220                  | 190                  |
| SDXC             | SDXC                 | SDXC                 | SDXC                 | MicroSD              |
| 106 x 61 x 33 mm | 93.2 x 57.0 x 20.0mm | 95.4 x 56.0 x 20.6mm | 97.2 x 56.4 x 22.5mm | 87.1 x 53.9 x 19.2mm |
| 224              | 135                  | 133                  | 144                  | 155                  |
| 8                | 6                    | 7                    | 8                    | 8                    |
| 8                | 6                    | 7                    | 8                    | 8                    |
| 8                | 6                    | 7                    | 7                    | 6                    |
| 8                | 7                    | 7                    | 7                    | 5                    |
| 8                | 7                    | 7                    | 7                    | 6                    |
| 8                | 6                    | 7                    | 7                    | 7                    |
| 7                | 7                    | 7                    | 7                    | 7                    |
| 7                | 6                    | 8                    | 8                    | 8                    |
| 7                | 6                    | 7                    | 7                    | 7                    |
| 6                | 6                    | 7                    | 7                    | 7                    |
| 5                | 6                    | 6                    | 7                    | 7                    |
| 5                | 6                    | 6                    | 6                    | 7                    |
| 5                | 6                    | 6                    | 6                    | 7                    |
| 8                | 6                    | 6                    | 7                    | 7                    |
| 7                | 6                    | 6                    | 7                    | 7                    |
| 6                | 6                    | 6                    | 6                    | 6                    |
| 6                | 5                    | 6                    | 6                    | 6                    |

## IMAGE PERFORMANCE

Now onto the meat of our shootout! The image quality test is always the most exciting and nerve racking if you ask us. We put our set of cameras through both a real world test, shooting scenes and situations that would most commonly occur in the life of an everyday casual photographer, along with shooting a simulated test target. We will first start with the findings of our real world test.

We shot a total of 10 scenes that would accurately reflect the real world usage of these cameras, ranging from Macro to landscape, to low light shots. The results are interesting, but the results fall within our expectations. Before we discuss the results, it is important to note that even though the sensor in these cameras is of the BSI type, it only means slightly better noise performance. The overall image quality is still determined by the sensor size, which in this case happens to be a miniscule 1/2.3-inch. The BSI sensor helps, but the small physical dimension of the sensor retains most of the limitations that come with the turf.

When looking for the best colour, we felt that the Panasonic SZ3 had the most pleasing renderings of greens and yellows, something we even saw in the Mirrorless Camera shootout. The overall tone of the images was warm, which works when shooting foliage up close, but it tends to not look so good when shooting people under warm lights. It did shoot some very sharp images though, thanks to the Leica optics.

Even in our real world shooting scenarios, we wanted to figure out which camera produced the most pleasing images, captured most infor-